

PAOLA UGALDE ARAYA

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Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA 70803

EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Louisiana State University, 2023-

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Arizona State University (2023)

M.S. Economics, Arizona State University (2021)

M.A. Economic Theory, ITAM (2017)

B.A. Economics, Universidad de Costa Rica (2013)

RESEARCH FIELDS

Applied Microeconomics, Labor Economics, Economics of Education, Gender Economics

RESEARCH

Published Papers

“The Impact of COVID-19 on Student Experiences and Expectations: Evidence from a Survey” with Esteban Aucejo, Jacob French, and Basit Zafar *Journal of Public Economics*, 2020

“A (Dynamic) Investigation of Stereotypes, Belief-Updating, and Behavior” with Katherine Coffman and Basit Zafar, *Economic Inquiry*, 2024

Working Papers

“Gendered Effects of Labels on Advanced Course Enrollment” (R&R)

“Gender Differences in Preferences for Grades and Major Choice” (Under Review)

“Same Degree, Different Education: The Transition to a 12-Year Curriculum in Louisiana” with Scott Abrahams

Research in Progress

“Understanding Gaps in College Achievement” with Esteban Aucejo, Jacob French, and Basit Zafar

“Political Views & College Choices in a Polarized America” with Riley Acton and Emily Cook

ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

2024: University of Costa Rica

2023: Louisiana State University, Rochester Institute of Technology, Tecnológico de Monterrey, Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Ohio State University

2022: Ph.D. Reunion Conference, Arizona State University

2020: Workshop on Subjective Expectations

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 2000), LSU: Spring 2024, Fall 2024

Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (ECON 4720), LSU: Fall 2023-Fall 2024

Microeconomics Principles (ECN 212), ASU: Summer 2020 and 2021

Principles of Economics (XE0156), UCR: Spring/Fall 2014, Spring 2015

AWARDS

2020-2021: Graduate Research and Support Program Grant

2020: Best Written Comprehensive Exam (Third-year paper)

2014: Graduation with Honors, B.A. Economics

2013, 2010: Best Student, Economics Department

March 2010 - December 2013: Academic Excellence Scholarship, B.A. Economics

REFeree

Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Higher Education, Empirical Economics, International Review of Economics, Management Science, Economic Bulletin, Economic Journal.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Gender: Female

Citizenship: Costa Rica

Languages: English (fluent), Spanish (native)